

Empathize and Discover: Empathy Map

Ideation Phase

Date	28-09-2026
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

This empathy map describes what the people involved in network service requests say, think, do and feel, and what frustrates or would help them. It draws on the challenges identified for the project: manual processing, approval delays, lack of visibility, repetitive IT effort and the need for automatic notifications. Two perspectives are mapped: the **Requester** who raises the request and the **Network Administrator** who fulfils it.

Map 1: The Requester

Network Service Requester

Goal: get network access or changes quickly, without chasing anyone

SAYS

what they voice out loud

- "Where is my request right now?"
- "Who needs to approve this?"
- "I need this done urgently."
- "Did anyone actually receive my email?"
- "Can someone please update me?"

THINKS

what runs through their mind

- Will my request be handled without needless delay?
- Have I given the network team everything they need?
- A simple form would save me a lot of time.
- Why do I always have to chase for updates?

DOES

what they actually do

- Sends requests by email, phone or ad-hoc forms
- Follows up with IT again and again
- Escalates when nobody responds
- Copies many people on long email chains
- Keeps personal notes to track status

FEELS

how the situation affects them

- Anxious when there is no update
- Frustrated by repeated follow-ups
- Unsure who owns the request
- Confident and relieved when timely notifications arrive

PAINS

frustrations and obstacles

- Manual, repetitive submission process
- Slow approvals and responses
- No visibility into request status
- Details lost across emails and chats
- No standard template or form
- Urgency is not clearly recognized

GAINS

what success looks like

- One portal for every network request
- Real-time tracking and status updates
- Automated approvals and notifications
- Guided, standard forms
- Mobile-friendly experience
- Confidence that urgent needs are handled

Map 2: The Network Administrator

Network Administrator (Fulfilment Team)

Goal: receive complete, approved requests and fix them fast

SAYS

what they voice out loud

- "This request is missing the IP range."
- "Who approved this change?"
- "Send me the complete details."
- "I have too many tickets to sort by hand."

THINKS

what runs through their mind

- I spend more time chasing details than configuring.
- Which requests are genuinely urgent?
- I need proof of approval before touching a firewall.
- There must be a smarter way to assign work.

DOES

what they actually do

- Reads emails and creates tickets manually
- Contacts requesters to fill missing information
- Assigns tasks to teammates by hand
- Updates requesters manually
- Documents changes after the fact

FEELS

how the situation affects them

- Overloaded by repetitive admin work
- Uncertain about priorities
- Concerned about compliance and traceability
- Satisfied when tasks arrive complete and assigned

PAINS

frustrations and obstacles

- Incomplete or unclear requests
- Manual sorting and assignment
- No standard process to follow
- High workload on the IT team
- No automated reminders
- Scattered audit trail

GAINS

what success looks like

- Pre-validated tasks created automatically
- Clear priority and SLA timers
- Complete approval and fulfilment history
- Fewer follow-up conversations
- Dashboard view of open workload

Key Insights and Design Response

Insight	Evidence from the map	Response in ServiceNow
Users cannot see progress	"Where is my request right now?"	Request status tracking and automatic notifications
Requests arrive incomplete	Admins chase missing IP ranges and ports	Dynamic catalog form with mandatory fields
Approvals are slow and untracked	"Who needs to approve this?"	Automated approval routing in Flow Designer
Manual sorting overloads admins	Tickets created and assigned by hand	Automatic task creation and assignment to the Network team
Urgency is unclear	"I need this done urgently."	Priority rules, urgent pathway and SLA escalation
Compliance needs proof	"Who approved this change?"	Approval and fulfilment audit history

Key insight: Requesters need a simple, transparent and automated way to submit, track and receive updates on network requests, while IT teams need standardization and automation to cut repetitive work. This points to an Automated Network Request Management solution built on ServiceNow.